Setting Up MySQL Connection in RapidMiner

Student Setup Guide

Prerequisites

- MySQL Server installed and running
- MySQL Workbench installed
- RapidMiner Studio installed
- MySQL JDBC Driver (mysql-connector-j-9.4.0.jar or similar)

Step 1: Download MySQL JDBC Driver

1. Go to: **https://dev.mysql.com/downloads/connector/j/**
2. Download the **Platform Independent** version (ZIP file)
3. Extract the ZIP file to your computer
4. Locate the **.jar** file (e.g., mysql-connector-j-9.4.0.jar)
5. Save it in an easy-to-find location (e.g., Desktop or Documents folder)

Step 2: Create Database Connection in RapidMiner

1. Open **RapidMiner Studio**
2. Go to **Repository** panel (left side of the window)
3. Right-click on **Connections** folder
4. Select **Create Connection** → **Database**
5. Give it a descriptive name (e.g., "AllElectronics_MySQL")

Step 3: Configure Connection - Info Tab

Click on the **Info** tab and fill in your database details:

Field	Value	Example

Host	localhost (or your server address)	localhost
Port	3306 (default MySQL port)	3306
Database name	Your database name	allelectronics
Username	Your MySQL username	root
Password	Your MySQL password	(your password)

Step 4: Configure Connection - Driver Tab

Click on the **Driver** tab and fill in the following information:

JDBC driver Jar file:

- Click the folder icon ■
- Browse to where you saved the MySQL connector JAR file
- Select **mysql-connector-j-9.4.0.jar**

JDBC driver class:

```
com.mysql.cj.jdbc.Driver
```

URL prefix:

```
jdbc:mysql://
```

Schema separator:

```
/
```

Leave "Import additional libraries" section empty (unless you have special requirements).

Step 5: Test Connection

1. Click the **Test connection** button at the bottom of the window
2. If successful, you'll see a success message ✓
3. If it fails, check the troubleshooting section below

Step 6: Save Connection

1. Click the **Save** button
2. The connection will now appear in your Connections folder
3. You can now use this connection in "Read Database" and "Write Database" operators

Quick Reference - Configuration Values

Field	Value
JDBC driver Jar file	`mysql-connector-j-9.4.0.jar`
JDBC driver class	`com.mysql.cj.jdbc.Driver`
URL prefix	`jdbc:mysql://`
Schema separator	`/`

Common Issues and Solutions

Problem: Driver class not found

Solution: Make sure you selected the correct .jar file and the complete file path is shown in the field.

Problem: Access denied for user

Solution: Check your MySQL username and password. Test them in MySQL Workbench first to ensure they work.

Problem: Unknown database

Solution: Make sure the database exists. You can create it in MySQL Workbench using: `CREATE DATABASE your_database_name;`

Problem: Connection timeout

Solution: Ensure MySQL server is running. Check in System Preferences (Mac), Services (Windows), or System Settings (Linux).

Important Notes

- Once set up correctly, you can reuse this connection in any RapidMiner process
- Keep your MySQL username and password secure
- The JDBC driver version may vary, but the setup process remains the same
- If you encounter any issues not covered here, contact your instructor